

Turn and learn

Cassini-Huygens:

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Planet names:

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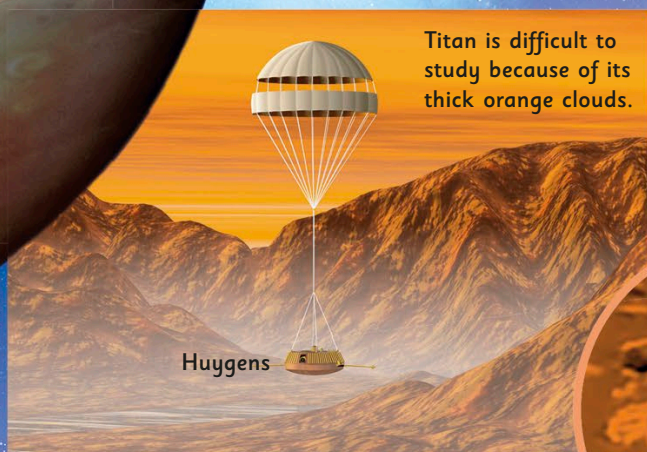
Each of Saturn's rings have a thickness of about 1 km (0.6 mile) or less. The seven main rings are made up of about 10,000 ringlets. They extend around 282,000 km (175,000 miles).



A mission to Saturn

In 1997, the *Cassini* spacecraft blasted off for Saturn with a spaceprobe named *Huygens* on board. *Cassini* went into orbit around Saturn in June 2004 and *Huygens* was dropped onto its largest moon, Titan, in January 2005.

... the Roman god of agriculture.



Titan is difficult to study because of its thick orange clouds.

Huygens

On the job!

Huygens took a little less than two and a half hours to descend to the surface of Titan, and then worked there for around an hour. It transmitted data for that entire duration, and remained active for far longer than anyone had hoped.



Huygens is now the furthest human-made object ever to land on a celestial body.

Vital statistics

Cassini sends back lots of information because of some of its amazing features.



The craft contains more than 12 km (7.5 miles) of **wires**.



It is the **size of a coach**, but is only a little heavier in weight than an elephant.



More than half its weight is made up by its **fuel**.



It carries a **camera** that could spot a coin from almost 4 km (2.5 miles).